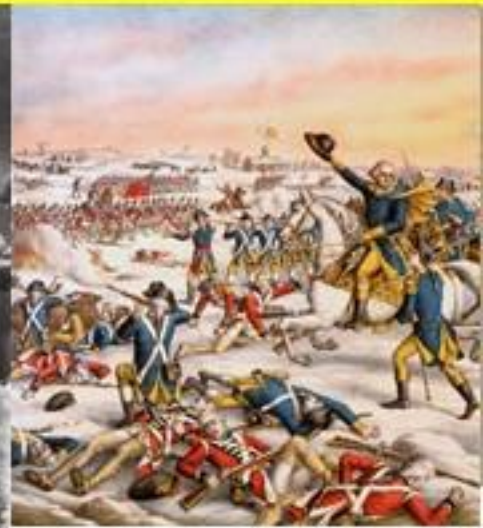


WORLD HISTORY



MODULE – 45

DECOLONIZATION AND NAM - 2

WHAT FORCED EUROPEAN POWERS TO ABANDON THEIR EMPIRES?

1 NATIONALIST MOVEMENTS

- Through the effects of westernisation and opening up, colonies acquired enlightened leadership and many developed strong nationalist movements.
- Most colonies were extensive police states. Massive unrest made them simply unviable.



2 SECOND WORLD WAR

- It weakened most European powers and they couldn't keep up with the maintenance of their empires.
- The most powerful among victorious powers – The USA and the USSR took a firm anti-colonial stance.
- This further weakened the Europeans.



WHAT FORCED EUROPEAN POWERS TO ABANDON THEIR EMPIRES?

3 PAN-AFRICANISM

- A feeling of brotherhood was growing within the indigenous people of Africa.
- This meant a pooling of resources and external support in the struggle for independence.
- As more and more countries attained freedom, the entire process was hastened.



4 OUTSIDE PRESSURES

- The USA and USSR actively pressurised colonial powers.
- Newly formed United Nations and other powerful international associations like the Non-Alignment Movement built up firm international opinions against colonialism.



- Africa faced many unique challenges which made Decolonisation a very difficult process.
- These were common to most of the new states in Africa.

1 TRIBAL DIFFERENCES

- 1 Many countries were brought together by the sheer military forces of the colonizers.
- 2 Lack of a common cultural past and tribal belligerence meant that they slaughtered each other inside these artificial boundaries imposed upon them.
- 3 This led to worst genocides in Nigeria, Congo (Zaire), Burundi and Rwanda.

2 COLD WAR RIVALRY

- 1 Since most of them were resource-rich, the two major blocs didn't want more states slipping into the orbit of its rival power.
- 2 This led to prolonged civil wars. Eg: Angola, Uganda, Burundi etc.



3 ECONOMIC UNDERDEVELOPMENT

- 1 Colonisers used them as sources of raw materials. So lack of industries and primitive agriculture made them susceptible to Neo-Colonialism.
- 2 Also, most of their economies were entirely dependent upon the export of one or two commodities.
- 3 When international prices fell, they plunged into political instability and civil wars. Eg: Nigeria, Ghana, Tanzania, Burundi etc.

4 POLITICAL AND SOCIAL PROBLEMS

- 1 Most colonial powers refused education to Africans.
- 2 This led to the deficiency in enlightened leadership and a general faith in democratic means.
- 3 This meant that most countries plunged into corruption and civil war soon after independence.



5 ECONOMIC AND NATURAL DISASTERS

1 Devastating famines of the 1980s and ongoing famines due to climate change are spelling disaster to these countries.

2 These events end up ruining economies and destabilising governments.

3 Through the 90s, the spread of the HIV/AIDS epidemic also posed a grave threat to these countries.

4 During the last two decades, climate change-induced disasters are seen to affect third world countries, especially those in Africa.



6 ETHNIC CONFLICT

- 1 In some countries with an influential white settler population, Decolonisation was a more complex affair.
- 2 They offered firm resistance because they were privileged under the old system. Eg: Rhodesia (Zimbabwe) and the erstwhile
- 3 Apartheid regime of South Africa. Sometimes, as in Zimbabwe, forced taking away of estates from the white minority led to an overall fall in productivity and caused economic crises.

7 RELIGIOUS EXTREMISM

- This is a fairly recent phenomenon in which Islamist ideologies taking over Muslim populations of these countries.
- Eg: Boko Haram in Nigeria, Al-Shabab in Somalia.



GENREAL TRENDS

- Due to these challenges and specific conditions in different countries, Decolonisation turned out different results for these countries.

i ARMY COUPS

- They were common in countries with weak leadership and limited mass base in democratic processes.
- Eg: Ghana, Nigeria, Uganda, Burundi, Rwanda, Congo etc.

ii EXPORT DEPENDENCY

Complete **export dependency** on one or two commodities leading to instability at times of falling prices. Eg: Nigeria, Ghana, Tanzania, Burundi etc.

iii EXTREME POVERTY

- It was the **characteristic** of most states due to lesser human development and corruption.



GENREAL TRENDS

iv RAMPANT CORRUPTION

- Most states fell into the hands of a corrupted elite that exploited social fissures to enrich itself.
- Recently we saw popular movements against Robert Mugabe of Zimbabwe and Jacob Zuma of South Africa succeeding in removing them.



v GREAT POWER RIVALRY

- It has affected many states like Angola badly. At the same time, these powers failed to interfere in places where their interests were not involved.
- Eg: Failure to stop the Rwandan genocide of 1994.
- This points to the need for a pan-African movement to ensure democracy and rule of law.



GENREAL TRENDS

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PREY TO NEO-COLONIALISM

- Resource-rich countries falling prey to Neo-colonialism and sectarian violence.
- Eg: Sierra Leone is locked in a perpetual civil war over its gold, diamond and iron ore deposits.
- China is accused of adopting Neo-colonial policies to exert influence over resource-rich Western Africa.
- The recent effort by India and Japan to build an Asia-Africa Growth corridor is seen as an effort to counter this.



GENREAL TRENDS

vii WIDESPREAD PROTESTS

- Many North African countries saw widespread protests at the time of 'Arab Spring' of 2011.
- Eg: Morocco, Tunisia, Libya and Egypt.
- But due to lukewarm responses from the outside world, many of them either fell under the influence of Islamist ideologies or were quelled through extreme violence.
- This was an opportunity lost in bringing democratic governance to entire northern Africa.



ROLE OF INDIA

- 1** After Indian independence, India supported Decolonisation strongly in International fora through the leadership of **Non-Alignment movement**.
- 2** India actively mobilised international opinion in favour of Decolonisation. In Indonesia and Africa, it was vocal in support.
- 3** It also sent troops to solve the **Congo Crisis** of the 1960s.
- 4** Besides, India contributes actively to the **UN peacekeeping forces** that operate in different parts of Africa.



WAY FORWARD

- 1** Decolonisation was a force of good that helped liberate billions of people across the globe from exploitation under an oppressive foreign rule.
- 2** As a cultural process, it is continuing to date. It ended up with the majority of the world achieving self-determination and self-rule.
- 3** Though the hegemonic nations still exert large influence through international trade, investment and technology control, these countries are free to script their own destiny. Majority of the so-called “Third world” is still mired in extreme poverty.



WAY FORWARD

- 4 The way forward is through human development, the spread of education and building of institutions through regional (Pan-African, Pan-South Asian collaboration etc.) cooperation.
- 5 Work of UN agencies is commendable in this regard. UN General Assembly has emerged as a potent forum where world opinion is mobilised in favour of third world countries.
- 6 Its powers and influence have to be enhanced.
- 7 The democratisation of international order will help the third world more in getting its grievances addressed and in building a more equitable world.



TIMELINE

S.NO	COUNTRY	YEAR OF INDEPENDENCE	IMPERIAL COUNTRY
1	Morocco	1956	France
2	Tunisia	1956	France
3	Ghana	1957	France
4	Guinea	1958	France
5	Cameroon	1960	France
6	Senegal	1960	France
7	Togo	1960	France
8	Mali	1960	France
9	Congo	1960	Belgium
10	Somalia	1960	Britain

TIMELINE

S.NO	COUNTRY	YEAR OF INDEPENDENCE	IMPERIAL COUNTRY
11	Chad	1960	France
12	Nigeria	1960	Britain
13	Tanzania	1961	Britain
14	Burundi	1962	Belgium
15	Rwanda	1962	Belgium
16	Algeria	1962	France
17	Uganda	1962	Britain
18	Kenya	1963	Britain
19	Zambia	1964	Britain
20	Gambia	1965	Britain

TIMELINE

S.NO	COUNTRY	YEAR OF INDEPENDENCE	IMPERIAL COUNTRY
21	Botswana	1966	Britain
22	Mauritius	1968	Britain
23	Mozambique	1975	Portugal
24	Angola	1975	Portugal
25	Zimbabwe	1980	Britain
26	Namibia	1999	South Africa

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